

MDViewer - Windows Security Guide

How to run MDViewer on Windows without a code signing certificate

1. Why does the warning appear?

MDViewer is distributed as a portable executable (.exe) without a code signing certificate. Code signing certificates are issued by trusted Certificate Authorities (CA) and cost approximately \$200~\$500 per year. Since MDViewer is an internal tool, we have not purchased a code signing certificate.

As a result, Windows SmartScreen and Windows Defender may display security warnings when you first run the application. This is normal behavior for any unsigned application and does not indicate that the file is malicious.

2. Windows SmartScreen Warning

When you first run MDViewer, you may see a blue dialog box that says: "Windows protected your PC - Microsoft Defender SmartScreen prevented an unrecognized app from starting."

To bypass this warning:

Step 1: Click "More info" link at the bottom of the warning dialog.

Step 2: A "Run anyway" button will appear at the bottom.

Step 3: Click "Run anyway" to launch MDViewer.

This only needs to be done once. Subsequent launches will not show this warning.

3. Windows Defender / Antivirus Warning

In some cases, Windows Defender or other antivirus software may flag the file. To add an exception:

Step 1: Open Windows Security (Settings > Privacy & Security > Windows Security).

Step 2: Go to "Virus & threat protection".

Step 3: Under "Virus & threat protection settings", click "Manage settings".

Step 4: Scroll down to "Exclusions" and click "Add or remove exclusions".

Step 5: Click "Add an exclusion" > "File" and select MDViewer.exe.

4. Group Policy (Enterprise Environment)

If your organization manages PCs via Group Policy or Intune, the IT administrator can whitelist the application by path or hash to prevent warnings for all users.

Contact your IT department to request an exception for MDViewer if the above steps are restricted by

policy.

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